

ODAWA NGALA

+254721333151 | odawangala99@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/odawa-ngala-54b980222/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/odawa-ngala-54b980222/) | github.com/odawaNg4l4

SUMMARY

Entry-level IT professional with hands-on infrastructure support experience and a security-first approach, built through self-directed cybersecurity training, and ongoing work as a technical trainer. Comfortable across Linux and Windows systems support, network troubleshooting, firewall and access-control setup, patching, and security monitoring with tools like Wazuh, Splunk, and Syslog. Looking to move into an ICT Security Intern role where I can keep IT operations running smoothly, tighten up security posture, and help the people around me build their own technical skills.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Trainer, CodeYetu (Voluntary)— Nairobi, Kenya | October 2023 – Present

- Teach foundational tech and coding skills, helping students go from basic concepts to real projects.
- Coach students through problem-solving and logical thinking, not just syntax.
- Run collaborative sessions where students learn from each other, not just from me.
- Introduce students to tools like Git and modern dev frameworks so they're ready for real-world work.
- Support students one-on-one through their projects — the goal is confidence and curiosity, not just finished code.

IoT & Systems Attachee, Psalmchmart — Nairobi, Kenya | June – September 2023

- Set up, configured, and maintained Linux systems and network devices — kept uptime and reliability high.
- Watched server logs and network activity to catch issues before they became real problems.
- Diagnosed and fixed hardware and system faults to keep disruptions to a minimum.
- Installed and configured OSes, drivers, and network services.
- Locked down access with firewall rules and restrictions.
- Found and patched vulnerabilities to cut down risk exposure.
- Helped with cloud infrastructure setup and monitoring.

PROJECTS

SOC & SIEM Self-Directed Research | Ongoing

- Building real SOC-analyst skills — log monitoring, alert triage — ahead of moving into a security-ops role.
- Working with Wazuh, Syslog, and Splunk.
- Getting hands-on with log collection, correlation rules, alerting, and how SIEM workflows differ across platforms.

IT Infrastructure - Women Techsters Fellowship | Ongoing

- Building practical skills in Linux administration, computer networking, system configuration, and IT infrastructure security.
- Working with firewalls, IDS/IPS, vulnerability scanning, and security monitoring in practical lab environments.
- Developing troubleshooting and system administration skills alongside foundational cybersecurity and incident response capabilities.
- Applying security best practices including system hardening, access control, monitoring, and data protection.

Hands-On IT & Cybersecurity Systems Labs | Ongoing

- Building hands-on experience through TryHackMe, Hack The Box, and self-directed Linux and networking labs.
- Practicing network configuration and reconnaissance, Windows and Linux administration, troubleshooting, vulnerability assessment, and SIEM fundamentals.
- Using practical lab environments to develop problem-solving, system troubleshooting, and technical investigation skills.
- Documenting technical findings and solutions to strengthen IT support, infrastructure management, and security operations capabilities.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Bioprocessing Engineering

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Women Techsters Fellowship Program (Cybersecurity Track) - Ongoing
- ISOC - Designing and Deploying Computer Networks
- Introduction to Cybersecurity Essentials - CISCO
- TryHackMe Cyber Security Learning Paths
- Ethical Hacker - CISCO
- Cyber Threat Management - CISCO
- Introduction to AI - HP

SKILLS

- Security Monitoring & Incident Response: SIEM & log analysis (Wazuh, Splunk, Syslog) · Alert triage and validation · Incident documentation and response basics · IOC identification · Endpoint and network log analysis
- IT Infrastructure & Systems Administration: Linux/UNIX admin · Windows Server basics · Server setup, config, hardening · Virtualization (VirtualBox/VMware) · VPN setup · System monitoring & performance
- Networking & Cloud: Network troubleshooting, TCP/IP · Firewall config, IDS/IPS (lab) · AWS (IAM, EC2) & Azure basics · Cloud integration
- Cybersecurity & Vulnerability Management: Vulnerability scanning & hardening · Risk awareness & best practices · Backup, restoration, continuity support · Security awareness & phishing simulation
- Hardware & Technical Support: Hardware diagnostics, repair, installs · Remote & onsite support · Wazuh, Splunk, Syslog, Kali Linux, Ubuntu, Nmap, Wireshark, Burp Suite, Git/GitHub, OpenVPN
- Soft Skills: Technical Problem-Solving · Analytical Thinking · Communication · User Support · Team Collaboration · Leadership · Time Management · Attention to Detail · Adaptability · Proactive Troubleshooting · Knowledge Sharing · Initiative